

# Word family: \*\*seat / seats / seated / seating\*\*

\*\*Base word:\*\* seat

\*\*Plural:\*\* seats

\*\*Past tense:\*\* seated

\*\*Past participle:\*\* seated

\*\* -ing form:\*\* seating

\*\*Related forms / useful compounds:\*\* seated, seating, seat belt, seat number

\*\*Part of speech:\*\* noun ( 名詞 ) / verb ( 動詞 )

Your sentence:

> “Ryan was the one who walked up to me, asked whether the \*\*seat\*\* beside me was free...”

## Meaning in this passage

Here, \*\*seat\*\* means a \*\*place designed for one person to sit\*\*, in this case probably a chair or desk-chair position in the classroom.

\*\*繁體中文\*\*： \*\*供一個人坐下的位置或座位，通常由椅子、長椅或其他坐具提供\*\*

\*\*中文翻譯\*\*：

> “...asked whether the \*\*seat\*\* beside me was free...”

「.....問我旁邊的\*\*座位\*\*有沒有人坐.....」

Here:

\*\*seat beside me = 我旁邊供人坐下的位置 / 座位\*\*

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# 1. \*\*seat = place for someone to sit ( 座位 ) — 座位 ; 位子\*\*

This is the meaning used in your passage.

\*\*Meaning:\*\* A place designed or intended for one person to sit.

### Practice 1 — Original

> “He asked whether the \*\*seat\*\* beside me was free.”

「他問我旁邊的\*\*座位\*\*有沒有人坐。」

### Practice 2

> “There were no empty **seats** on the train.”

「火車上沒有空的**座位**。」

### ### Practice 3

> “Please take a **seat** near the front.”

「請在前面附近找個**座位**坐下。」

**seat** = 供一個人坐下的指定位置或位子

Common:

- \* empty seat
- \* window seat
- \* aisle seat
- \* front seat
- \* back seat
- \* reserved seat

These are all one underlying sense.

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# 2. **seat** = physical part of a chair/vehicle that you sit on ( 坐具的座面 ) — 座面 ; 坐墊部分

Sometimes **seat** means specifically the physical part of a chair, bicycle, vehicle, etc. that supports your body when you sit.

### ### Practice 4

> “The **seat** of the chair was made of wood.”

「這張椅子的**座面**是木製的。」

### ### Practice 5

> “The bicycle **seat** was too high for me.”

「單車的**座位 / 坐墊**對我來說太高。」

**seat** = 椅子、車輛或其他坐具中直接承托身體、供人坐上的部分

This is very closely related to Meaning 1, but the focus shifts from:

> **the place allocated to a person**

to:

> **the physical component they sit on**

For database counting, I would probably merge these under one broad **sitting place/surface** concept unless you want a very fine physical distinction.

The Golden Manual tells us not to split closely related contexts when one broader definition explains them naturally.

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# 3. **seat** = position in an elected body / parliament ( 議會 / 選舉 ) — 議席 ; 席位

This is a genuinely different meaning.

**Meaning:** An official position as a member of a parliament, council, legislature, committee, etc.

#### ### Practice 6

> “The party won three additional **seats** in the election.”

「該政黨在選舉中多取得了三個**議席**。」

#### ### Practice 7

> “She has held a **seat** on the council for six years.”

「她已在議會 / 委員會擔任**席位**六年。」

**seat** = 在議會、理事會、委員會或其他正式機構中代表成員身分的一個職位 / 名額

This does not mean the physical chair.

Compare:

> “There are 500 seats in the hall.”

= 大堂有五百個座位。

> “The party won 50 seats.”

= 政黨取得五十個議席。

Different mental concepts.

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# 4. \*\*seat = position/place of authority or activity ( 中心 / 所在地 ) — 所在地 ; 中心\*\*

\*\*Seat\*\* can mean the principal place where a government, institution, authority, or important activity is based.

### Practice 8

> “The city became the \*\*seat of government\*\*.”

「這座城市成為\*\*政府所在地 / 政治中心\*\*。」

### Practice 9

> “The university town was once a major \*\*seat of learning\*\*.”

「這個大學城曾經是重要的\*\*學術中心\*\*。」

\*\*seat of + institution/activity = 某種權力、政府、學術或重要活動集中並運作的中心 / 所在地\*\*

Common:

\* seat of government

\* seat of power

\* seat of learning

This is more formal, but it remains established modern English.

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# 5. \*\*seat + person ( 動詞 ) — 安排 / 讓某人坐下\*\*

As a verb, \*\*seat\*\* means to place or arrange someone in a sitting position or assign them a seat.

### Practice 10

> “The waiter \*\*seated\*\* us near the window.”

「侍應安排我們\*\*坐在窗邊\*\*。」

### Practice 11

> “Guests were **\*\*seated\*\*** according to the seating plan.”

「賓客按照座位安排**\*\*就座\*\***。」

**\*\*seat someone** = 安排某人坐在指定位置，或給某人安排座位**\*\***

This is the main verb meaning.

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# 6. **\*\*seat + number of people ( 容量 ) — 可容納.....人就座\*\***

A place or vehicle can **\*\*seat\*\*** a particular number of people.

### Practice 12

> “The theatre **\*\*seats\*\*** 800 people.”

「這間劇院**\*\*可容納八百人就座\*\***。」

### Practice 13

> “The car can **\*\*seat\*\*** seven passengers.”

「這部車**\*\*可以坐七名乘客\*\***。」

**\*\*seat + number of people** = 某個地方、車輛或設施具有足夠座位，可讓指定人數坐下**\*\***

This is related to the verb **\*\*seat someone\*\***, but the subject is now the venue or vehicle.

For core counting, I would normally merge this with Meaning 5 under:

> **\*\*provide/assign seating\*\***

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# Related form: **\*\*seated\*\***

**\*\*Seated\*\*** means sitting down or placed in a seat.

### Practice 14

> “Everyone was already **\*\*seated\*\*** when the speaker arrived.”

「講者到達時，所有人都已經**\*\*就座\*\***。」

### ### Practice 15

> “Please remain **\*\*seated\*\*** until the train stops.”

「火車停下之前請保持**\*\*坐着 / 留在座位上\*\***。」

**\*\*seated = 已坐下或處於座位上的\*\***

This is more formal than simply:

> sitting

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# Related form: **\*\*seating\*\***

**\*\*Seating\*\*** can mean the seats provided in a place, or the arrangement of those seats.

**## \*\*seating = seats provided ( 座位設施 ) \*\***

### ### Practice 16

> “The café has outdoor **\*\*seating\*\***.”

「這間咖啡店有戶外**\*\*座位\*\***。」

### ### Practice 17

> “Additional **\*\*seating\*\*** was added for the event.”

「活動增加了額外的**\*\*座位設施\*\***。」

**\*\*seating = 某個地方提供給人坐的全部座位\*\***

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**## \*\*seating = arrangement of seats/people ( 座位安排 ) \*\***

### ### Practice 18

> “The **\*\*seating\*\*** was arranged by family group.”

「**\*\*座位安排\*\***是按照家庭組別來編排的。」

### ### Practice 19

> “Check the **seating plan** before the dinner begins.”

「晚宴開始前先查看**座位表 / 座位安排**。」

**seating** = 座位如何排列，或人物如何被分配到不同座位

These are closely related and need not be split as separate core meanings.

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# Useful compound: **seat belt**

### Practice 20

> “Please fasten your **seat belt**.”

「請扣好**安全帶**。」

### Practice 21

> “All passengers must wear **seat belts**.”

「所有乘客都必須佩戴**安全帶**。」

**seat belt** = 車輛或飛機座位上用來固定乘客身體、減少意外受傷風險的安全帶

This is a compound, not another meaning of bare **seat**.

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# Fixed expression: **take a seat / have a seat** — 坐下

### Practice 22

> “Please **take a seat**.”

「請**坐下 / 請就座**。」

### Practice 23

> “Come in and **have a seat**.”

「進來吧，**坐下來**。」

**take/have a seat** = 坐下來

This is one of the most useful fixed constructions built from the ordinary seat meaning.

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# Fixed expression: \*\*on the edge of your seat — 緊張期待；看得非常投入\*\*

#### ### Practice 24

> “The final scene kept everyone \*\*on the edge of their seats\*\*.”

「最後一幕令所有人都\*\*緊張投入、看得非常入神\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 25

> “The match had us \*\*on the edge of our seats\*\* until the end.”

「那場比賽直到最後都令我們\*\*緊張得坐不住 / 非常投入\*\*。」

\*\*on the edge of your seat = 因緊張、興奮或期待而高度投入\*\*

This is an idiom, not another core meaning.

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# Fixed expression: \*\*take a back seat — 退居次要位置\*\*

#### ### Practice 26

> “Work has taken a \*\*back seat\*\* since the baby was born.”

「孩子出生後，工作已經\*\*退居次要位置\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 27

> “Personal ambitions had to take a \*\*back seat\*\*.”

「個人抱負不得不\*\*暫時放在次要位置\*\*。」

\*\*take a back seat = 不再處於主要或優先位置，退居次要地位\*\*

Again, useful idiom rather than core lexical sense.

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# Important distinction: \*\*seat vs chair\*\*

### \*\*chair\*\*

= the physical piece of furniture

### \*\*seat\*\*

= the place/part where someone sits

A chair normally provides:

> one seat.

But a:

> bench

may provide several seats without being several chairs.

Similarly:

> "Your seat is 12A."

does not mean:

> "Your chair is called 12A."

So:

\*\*chair = 椅子這件家具\*\*

\*\*seat = 坐的位置 / 座位\*\*

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# Important distinction: \*\*seat vs place\*\*

A \*\*place\*\* is much broader.

> "Save me a place."

may mean reserve a position.

### \*\*seat\*\*

specifically concerns somewhere to sit.

> “Save me a seat.”

= 幫我留一個座位。

So:

**\*\*every seat is a place\*\***

but:

**\*\*not every place is a seat\*\***

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# Important distinction: **\*\*seat vs sit\*\***

These are often confused.

### **\*\*seat\*\***

normally:

\* noun = 座位

\* transitive verb = 安排某人坐下

> “The waiter seated us.”

### **\*\*sit\*\***

usually means the person themselves adopts a sitting position.

> “We sat near the window.”

So:

> “Please sit.” 

> “Please seat.” 

unless there is an object:

> “Please seat the guests.” 

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# Important distinction: **\*\*seated vs sitting\*\***

### \*\*sitting\*\*

is the ordinary everyday description:

> “She is sitting by the window.”

### \*\*seated\*\*

is more formal and focuses on being positioned in a seat:

> “She remained seated.”

Both can describe the same physical state, but register differs.

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# Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

\* \*\*seat\*\*

\* \*\*seats\*\*

\* \*\*seated\*\*

\* \*\*seating\*\*

Useful compounds and expressions include:

\* seat number

\* window seat

\* aisle seat

\* seat belt

\* seating plan

\* take a seat

\* on the edge of your seat

\* take a back seat

The Golden Manual says useful compounds and fixed expressions should be included when they add learning value, but should not be mislabeled as separate base-word meanings.

# Master comparison

| Form / sense | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|--------------|---------------------------------------|
|--------------|---------------------------------------|

|       |       |
|-------|-------|
| ----- | ----- |
|-------|-------|

|                              |                |  |
|------------------------------|----------------|--|
| **seat — place for sitting** | 供一個人坐下的指定位置或座位 |  |
|------------------------------|----------------|--|

|                                     |                                          |  |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|--|
| **seat — physical sitting surface** | 椅子、車輛或其他坐具中直接承托身體、供人坐上的部分；<br>與一般座位義高度相關 |  |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|--|

|                                              |                                 |  |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--|
| <b>**seat — official position**</b>          | 在議會、理事會、委員會等正式機構中代表成員身分的一個職位或名額 |  |
| <b>**seat of government/power/learning**</b> | 某種政府、權力、學術或重要活動集中和運作的所在地 / 中心   |  |
| <b>**seat someone — verb**</b>               | 安排某人坐在指定位置或給某人安排座位              |  |
| <b>**venue/vehicle seats X people**</b>      | 某個地方或交通工具可提供足夠座位讓指定人數就座         |  |
| <b>**seated**</b>                            | 已坐下或處於座位上的；較正式                  |  |
| <b>**seating**</b>                           | 某場所提供的座位，或座位 / 人物的排列方式          |  |

# For your original sentence

> “...asked whether the **\*\*seat\*\*** beside me was free...”

The exact meaning is:

**\*\*seat = 供一個人坐下的位置 / 座位\*\***

More specifically:

**\*\*the seat beside me = 我旁邊那個可以讓另一個人坐下的位置\*\***

So:

> **\*\*Is the seat beside you free?\*\***

= **\*\*你旁邊的座位有人坐嗎 / 那個座位空着嗎？\*\***

For your database, I would count **\*\*4 genuinely distinct core meanings\*\*** for **\*\*seat\*\***:

1. **\*\*a place/surface for someone to sit\*\***
2. **\*\*an official position in a parliament, council, committee, etc.\*\***
3. **\*\*a centre or location of authority/activity — seat of government/power\*\***
4. **\*\*verb — place someone in a seat / provide seating capacity\*\***

I would merge **\*\*chair seat / car seat / classroom seat\*\*** under #1, merge **\*\*seat 500 people\*\*** into the verb family under #4, and keep **\*\*take a seat, take a back seat, on the edge of your seat\*\***, and **\*\*seat belt\*\*** as fixed or compound extensions rather than inflate the core count.